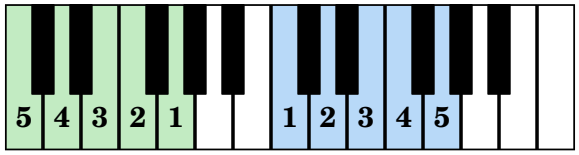
Unit 5

Hands Together

New: Left hand holds C or G while the right hand moves

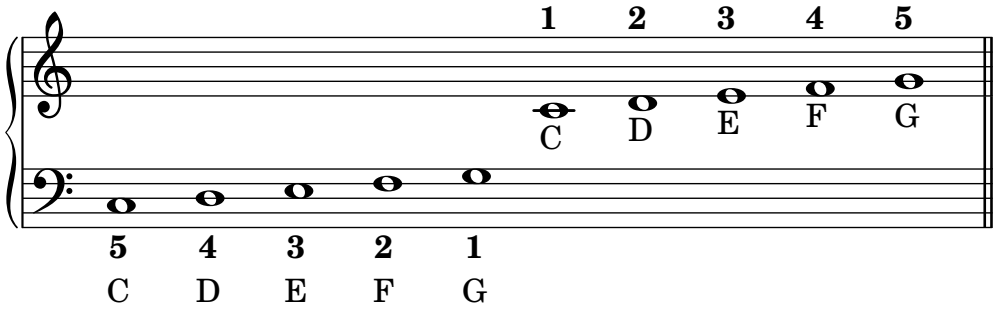
Both hands now play at the same time. To make this manageable, the left hand keeps it simple: it holds long notes, only C (finger 5) or G (finger 1), while the right hand plays the tune. These two bass notes are the roots of the two most important chords in C major.



Middle C

Left hand C position and Right hand C position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes



What is new

Reading two staves at once

Notes that line up vertically are played together. Read the beat as a column: the right-hand note on top, the left-hand note below.

C and G in the bass

C sits in the second space (finger 5) and G in the top space (finger 1). In this unit those are the only two left-hand notes.

Where the bass changes

The left hand changes only on beat 1 (whole notes) or on beats 1 and 3 (half notes). Between those moments, spend all your attention on the right hand.

Reading tips

1. Before you start, find the first note in each hand and put both hands in place.

2. Read the top line. Glance down only when a new bass note is due, on beat 1 or beat 3.

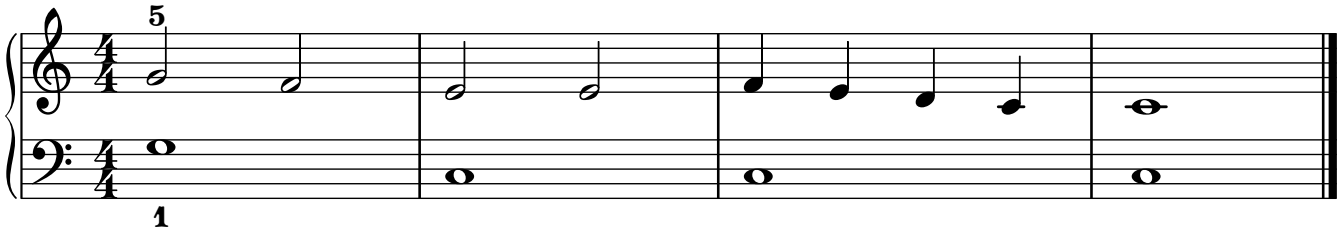
3. If playing hands together falls apart, keep the right hand going and let the left hand drop out for a bar. Never stop the beat.

4. Count aloud. Hands together is mostly a counting skill.

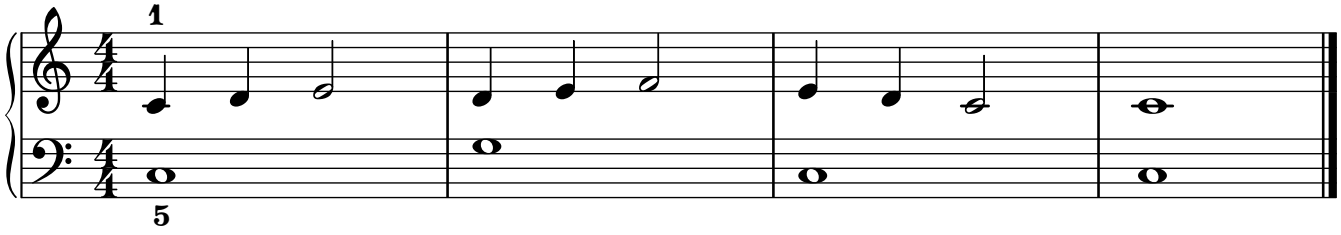
Part A: Whole-note bass ♩ = 56

The left hand holds one whole note per bar: C or G. The right hand moves by step. Metronome 56.

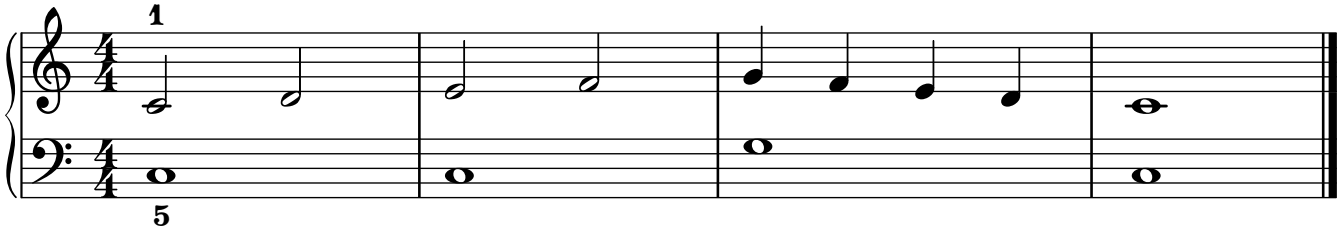
☐ **5.1**



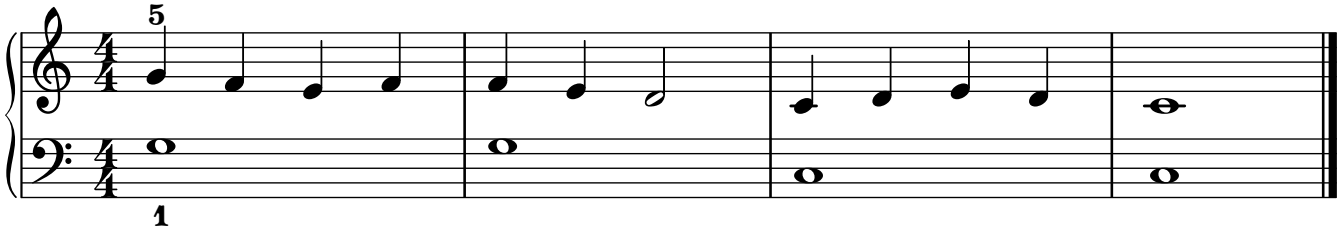
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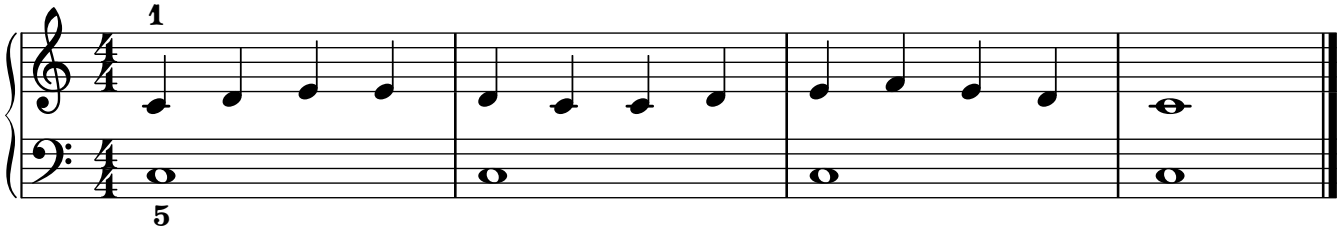
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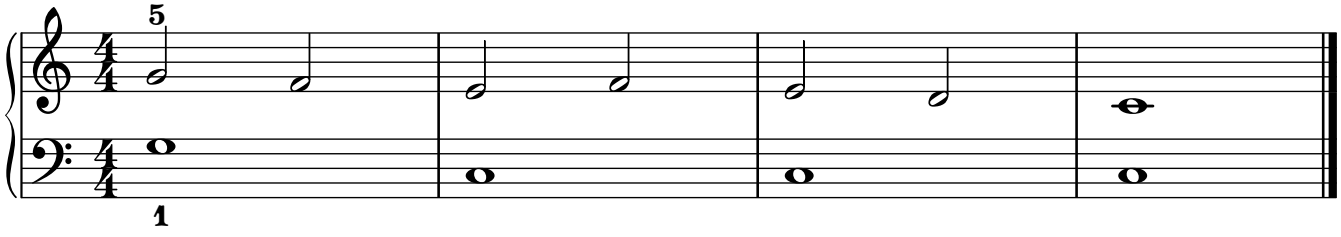
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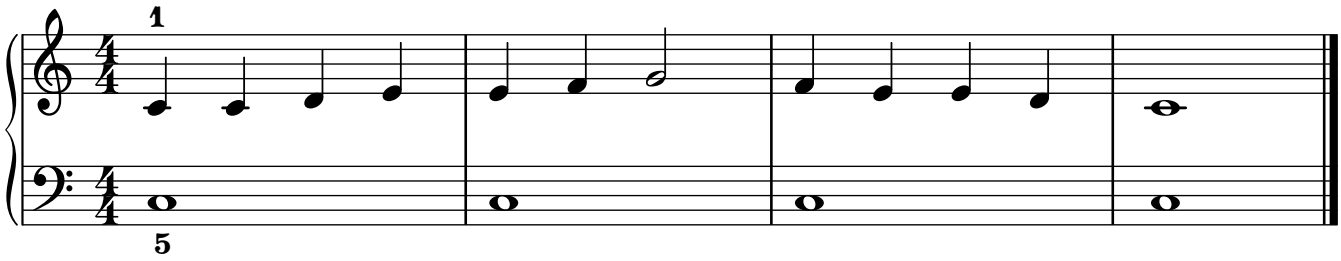
☐ **5.5**



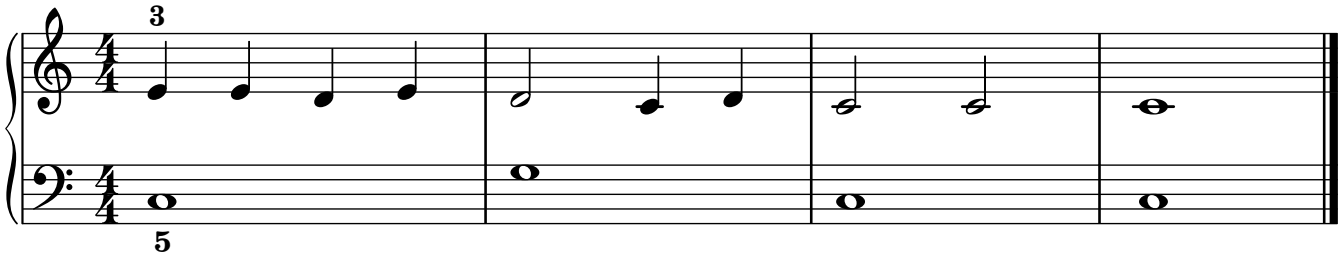
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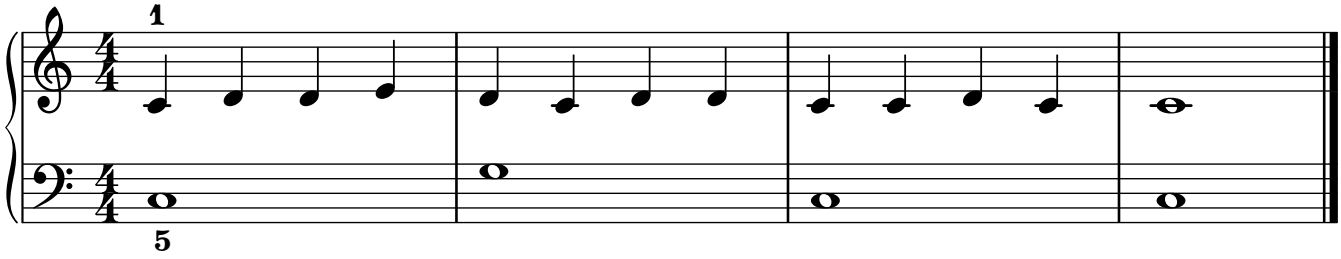
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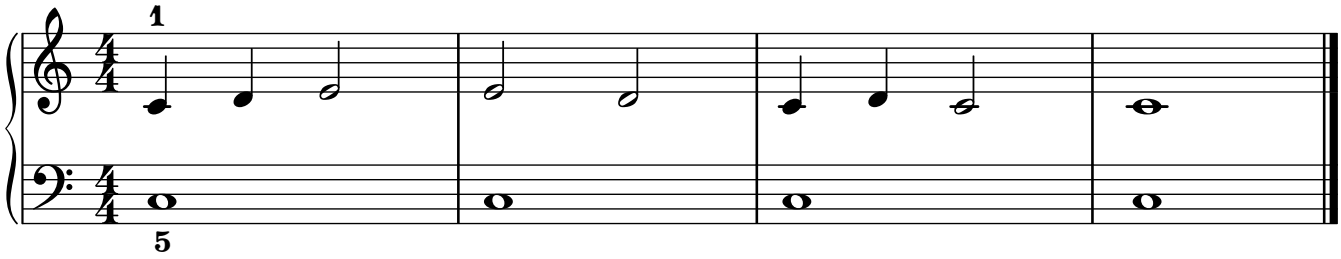
☐ **5.8**



☐ **5.9**



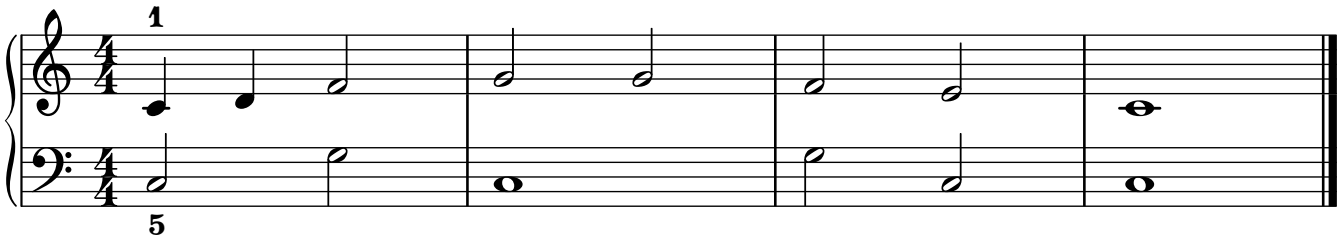
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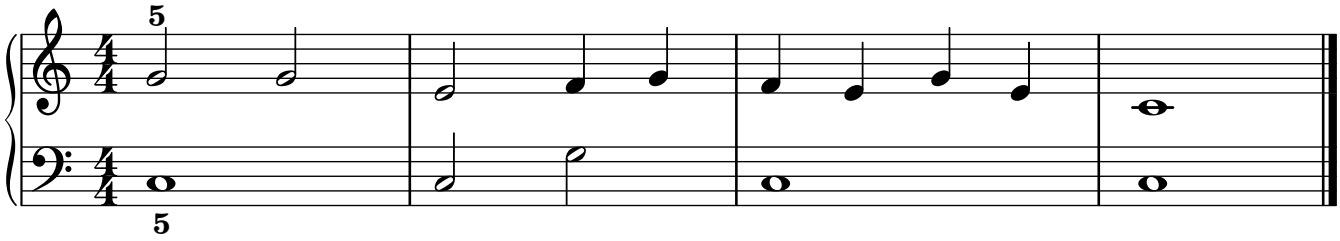
Part B: Half-note bass ♩ = 56

The left hand may change on beat 3 (half notes), and the right hand uses skips too.
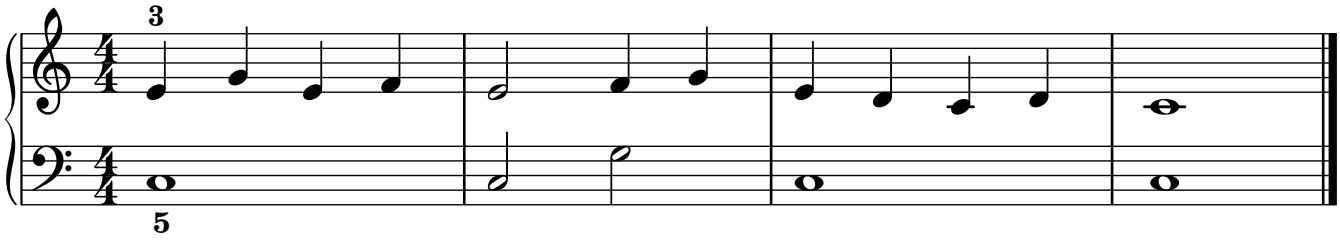
☐ **5.11**



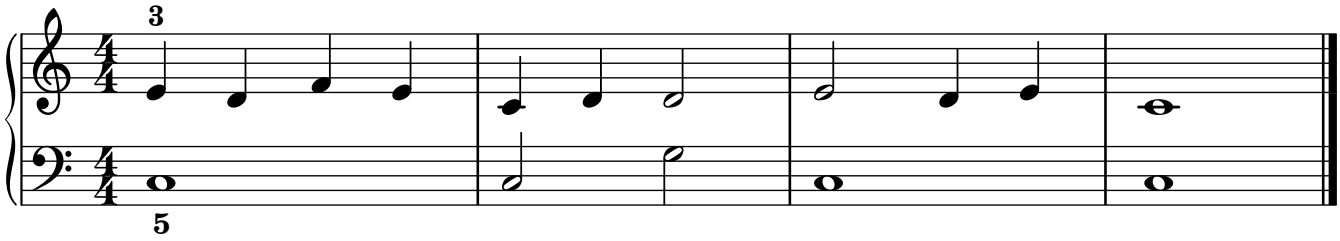
☐ **5.12**



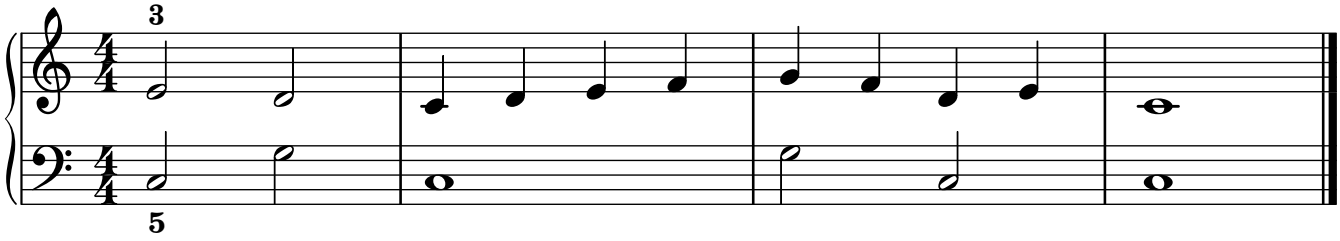
☐ **5.13**



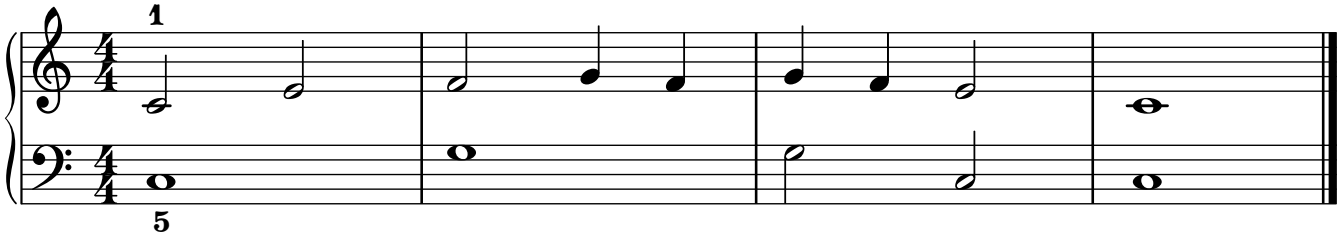
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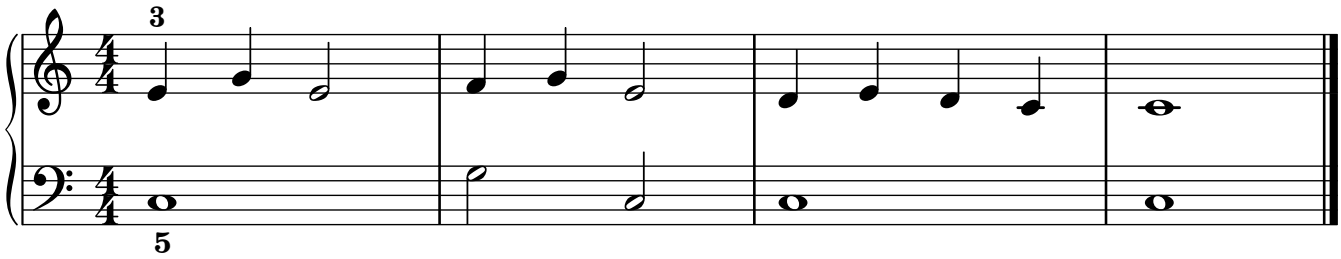
☐ **5.15**



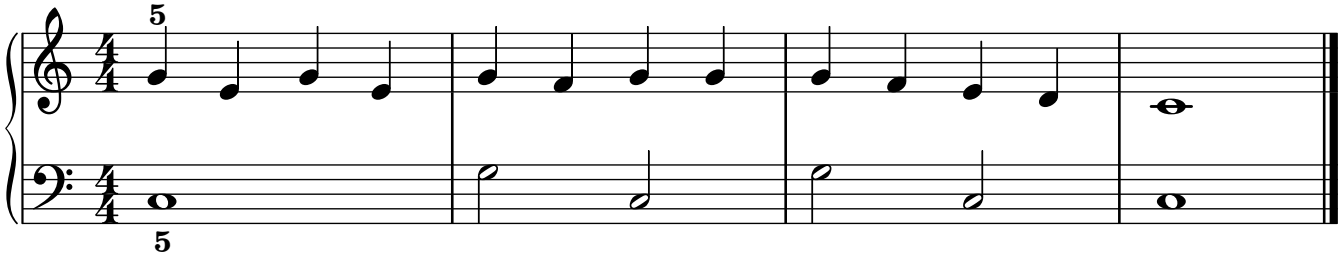
☐ **5.16**



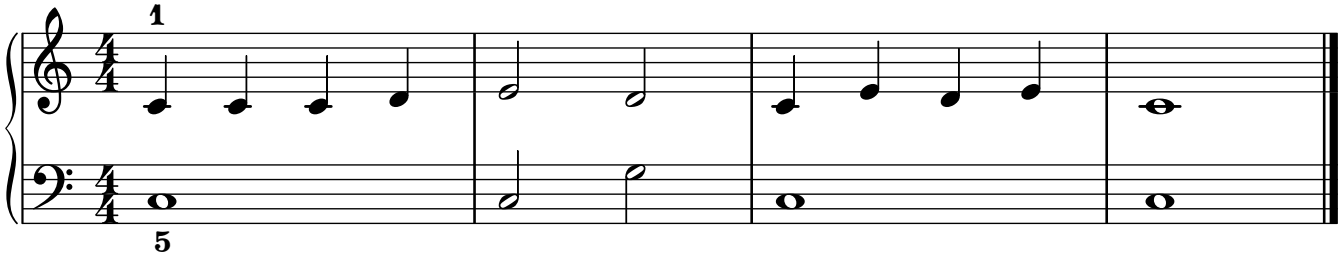
☐ **5.17**



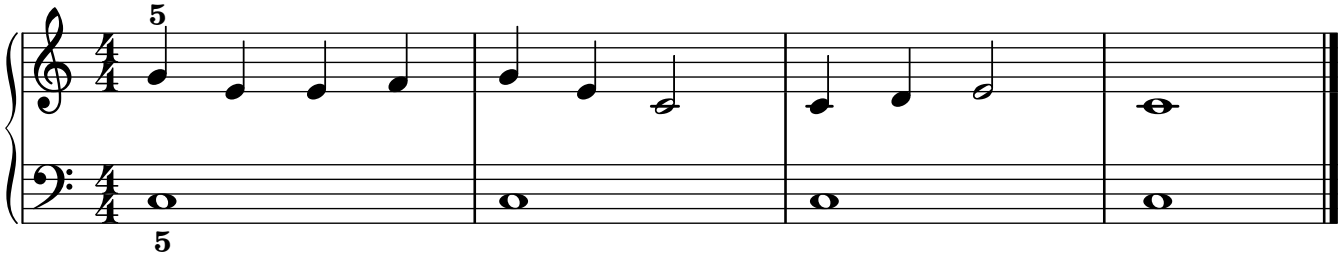
☐ **5.18**



☐ **5.19**
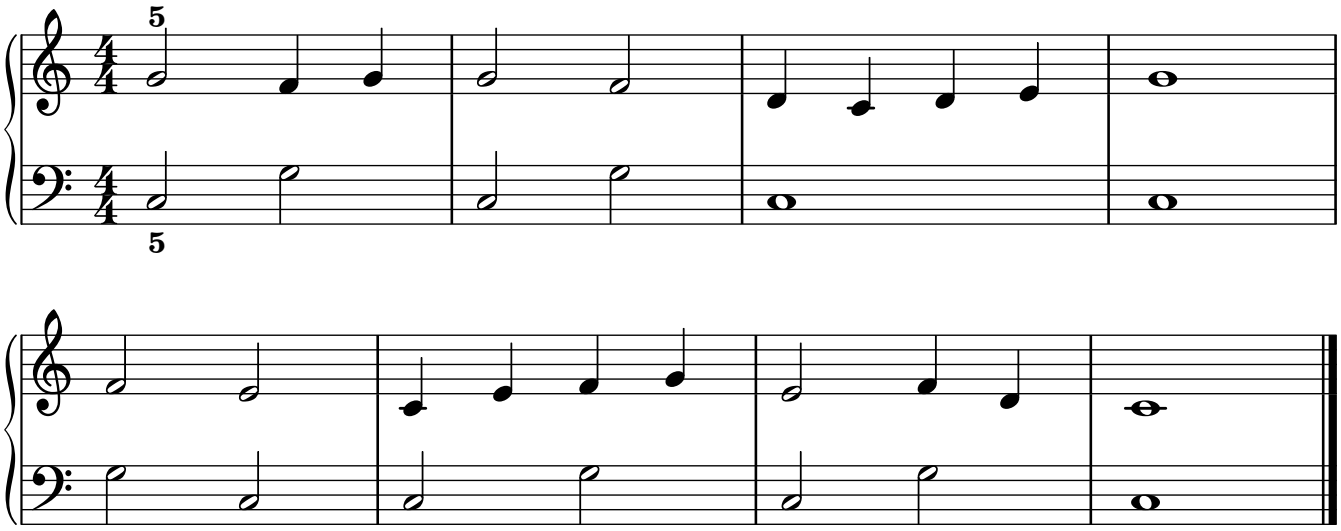


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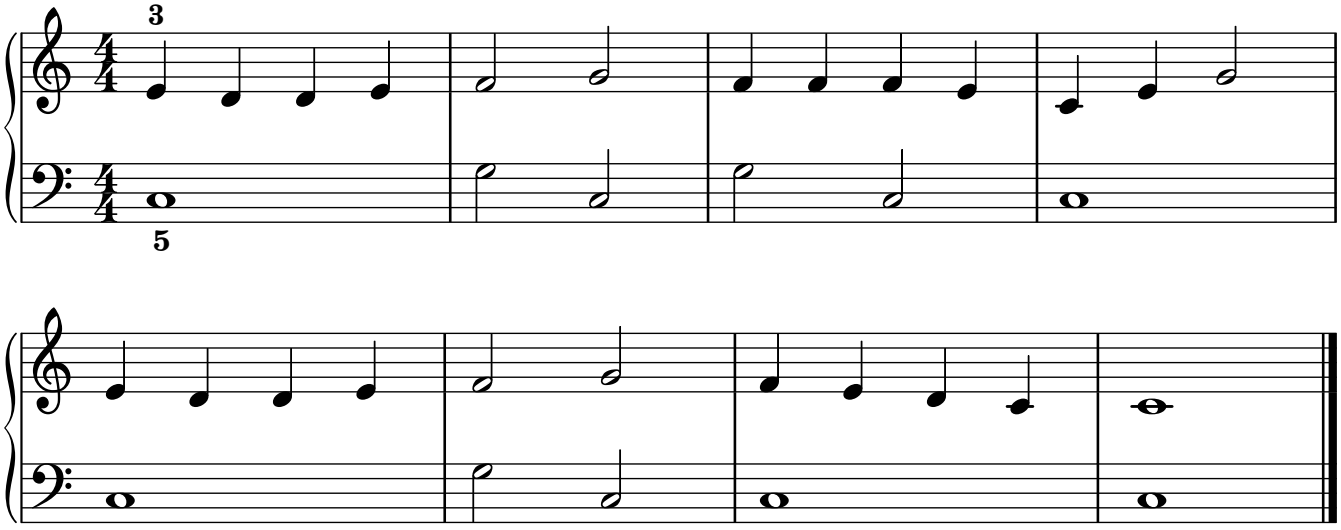


Part C: Eight-bar duets for two hands ♩ = 60

Eight-bar duets for your two hands.
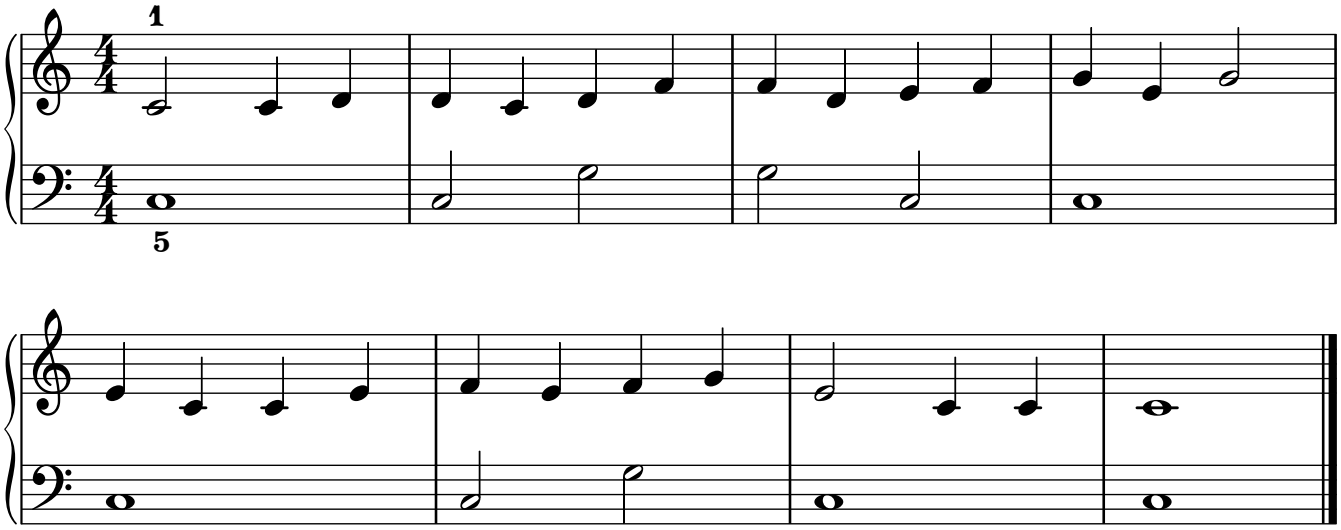
☐ **5.21**
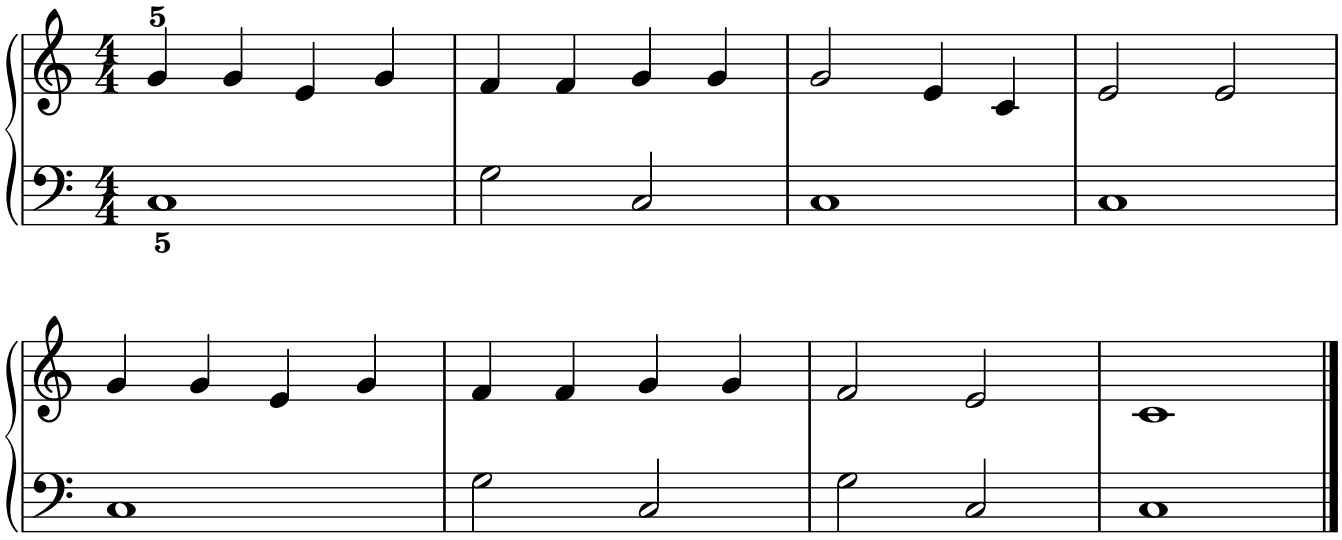


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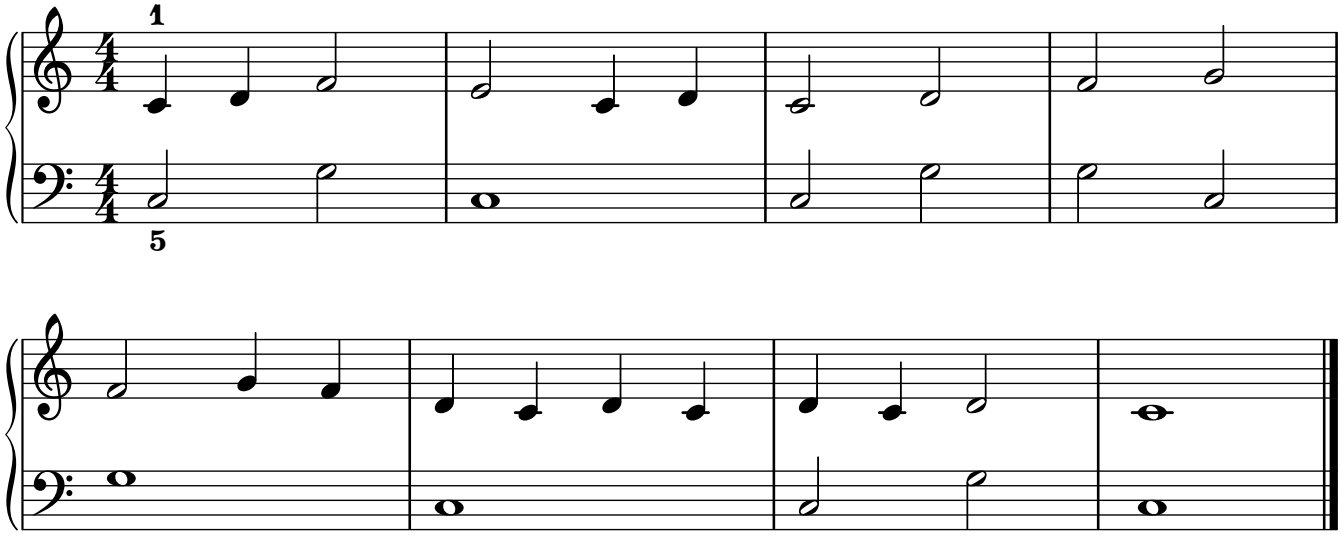


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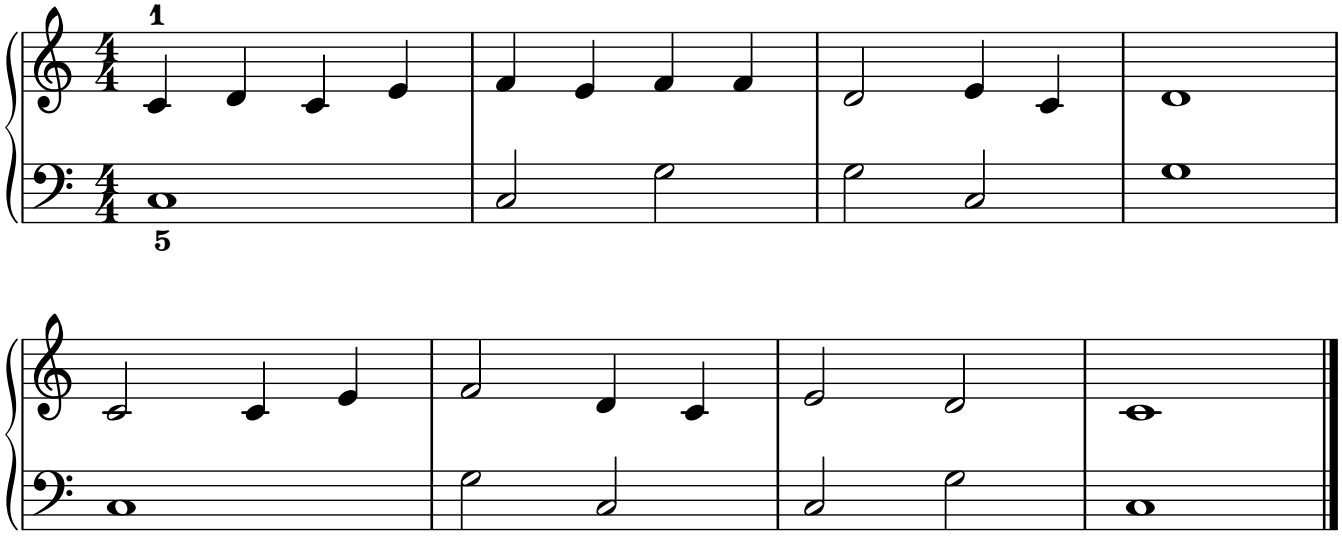


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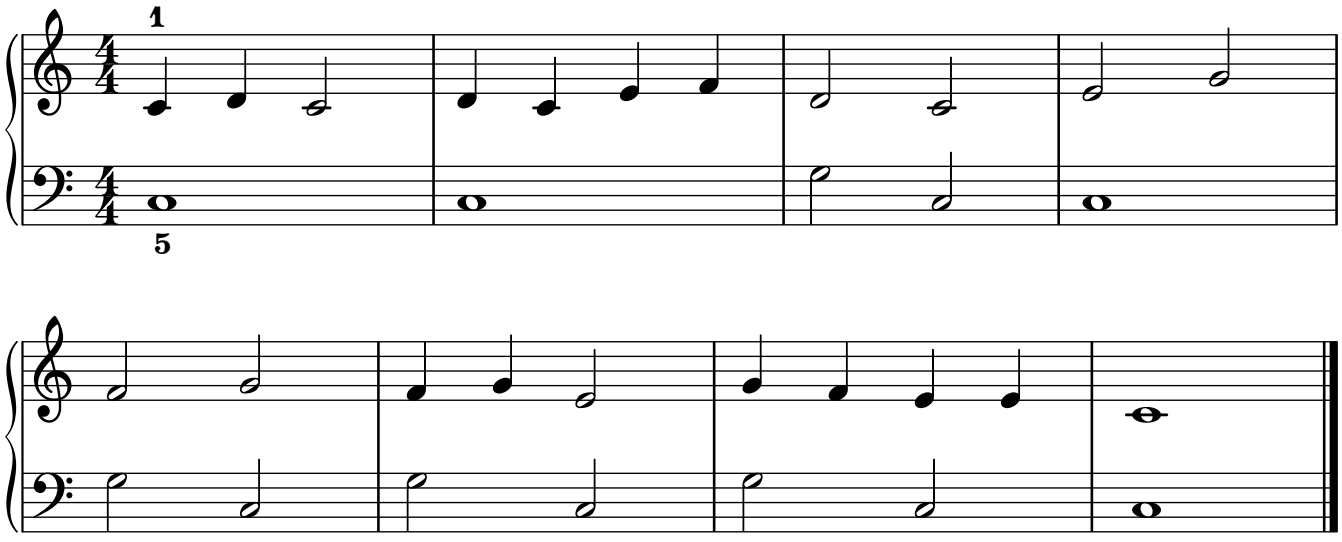


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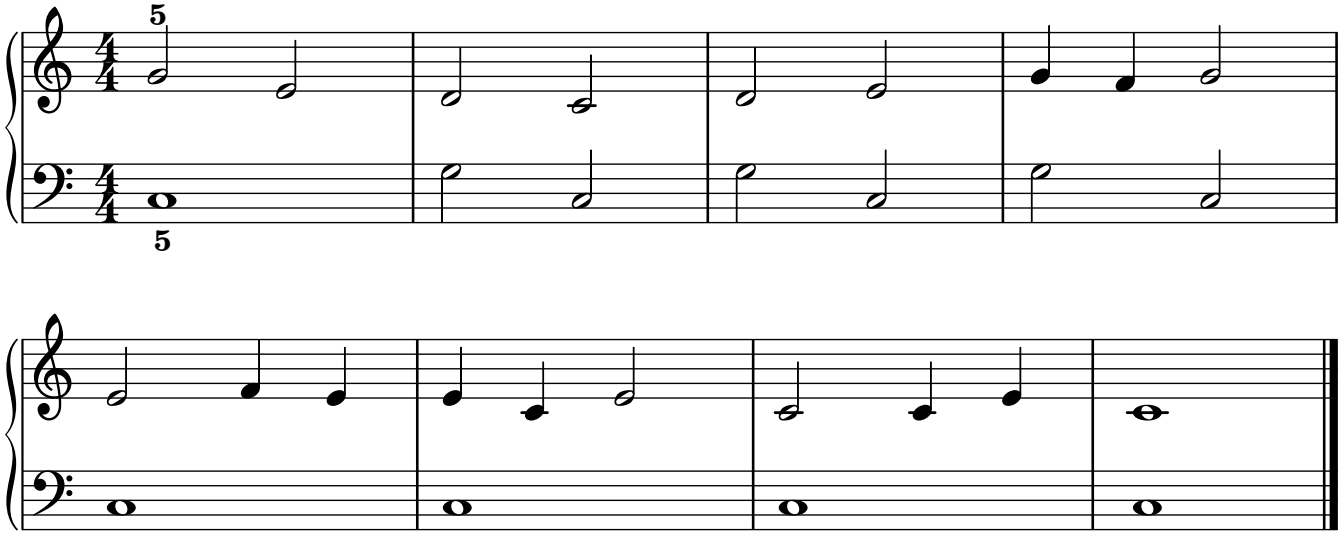
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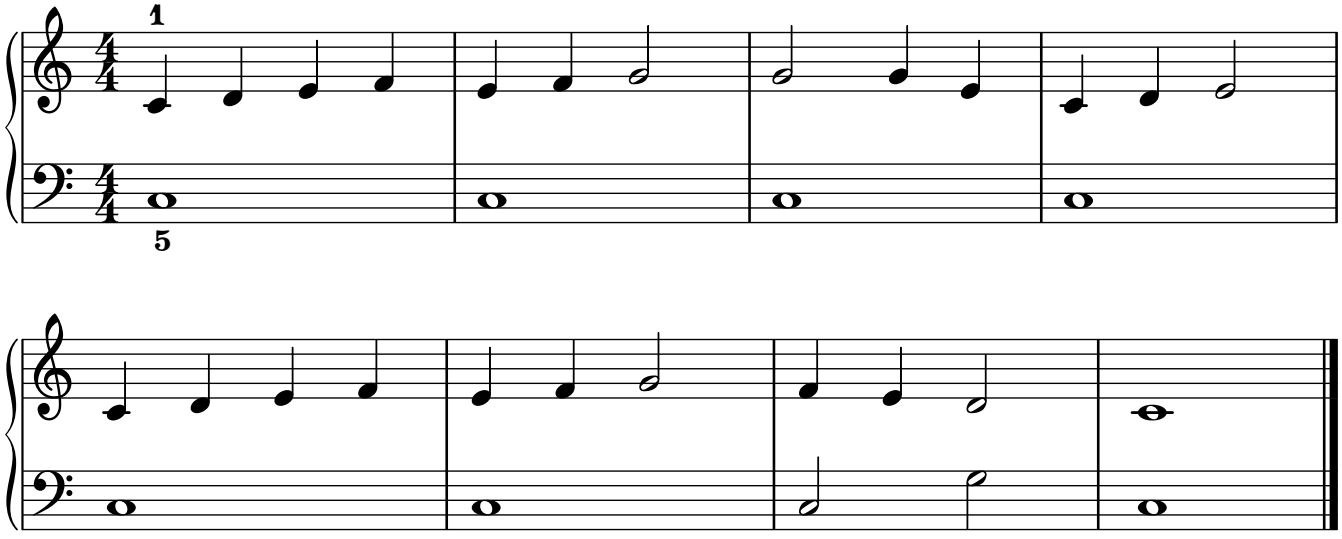


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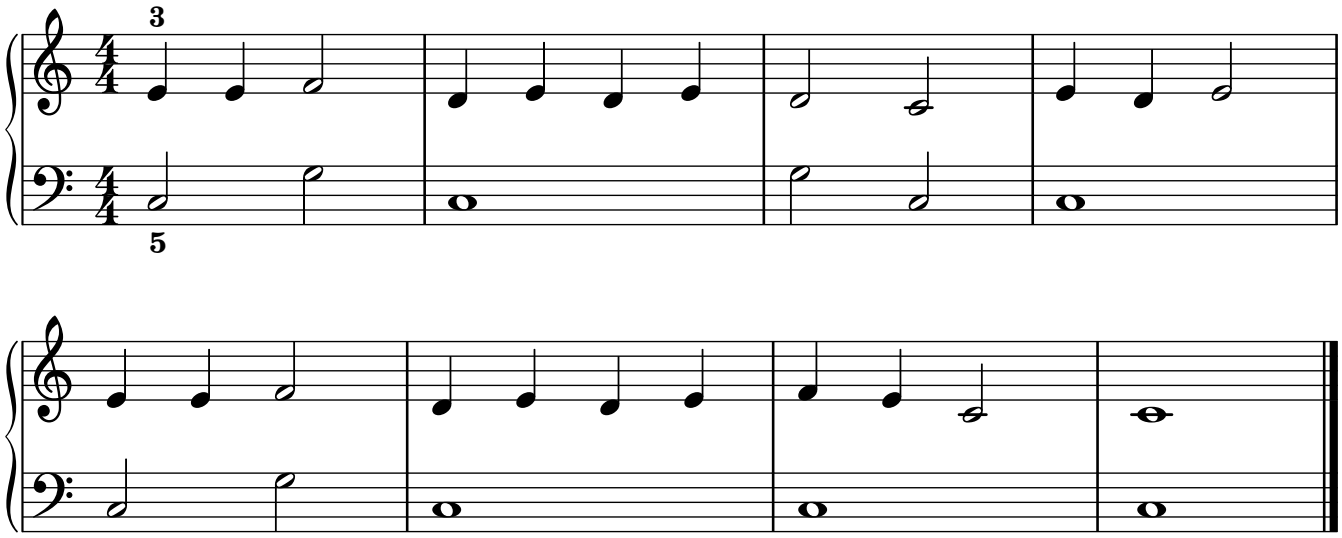


5.28



5.29



5.30



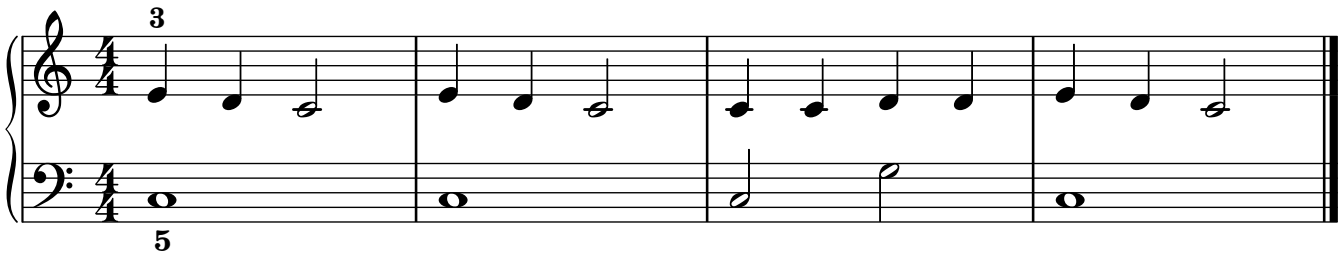
Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Hot Cross Buns (hands together) ♩ = 72

Traditional (bar 3 simplified to quarter notes)

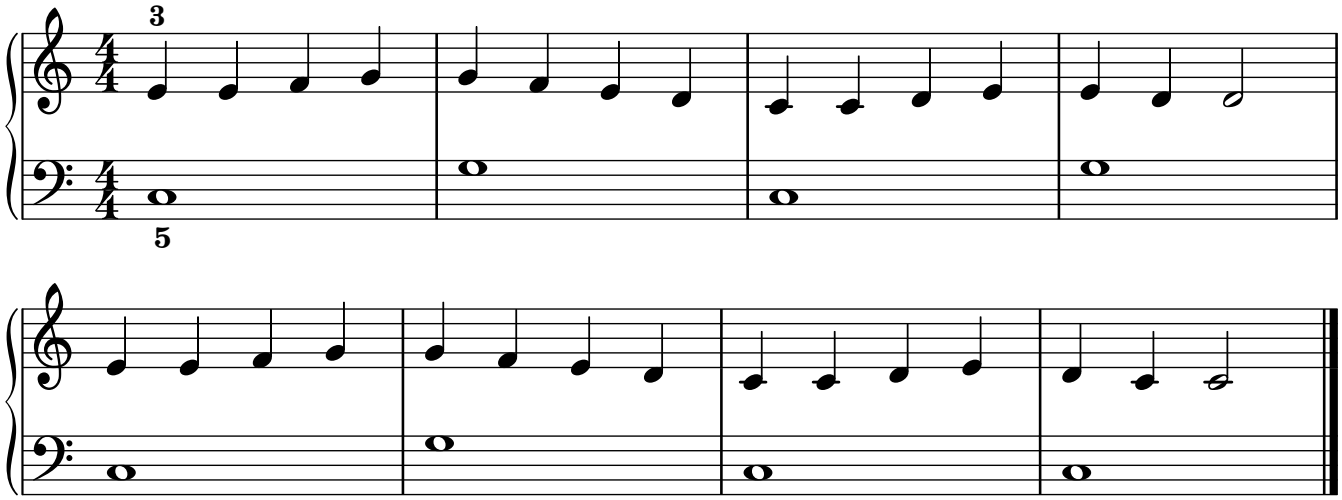
The left hand holds C, and changes to G only once, in bar 3.



Ode to Joy (hands together) ♩ = 76

Ludwig van Beethoven (1824), simplified
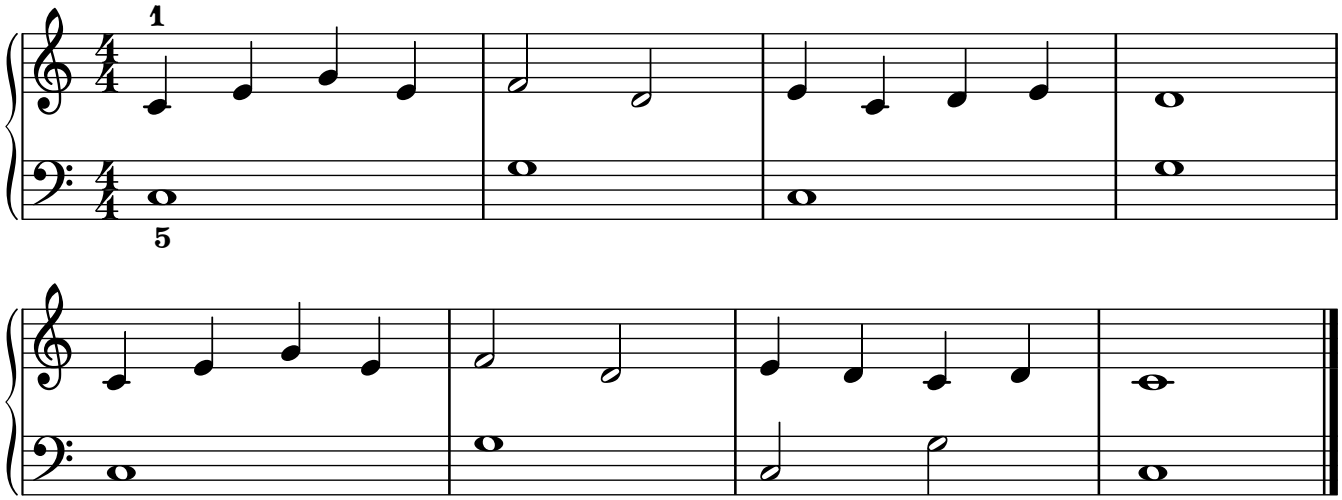
The bass alternates C and G every bar, then stays on C at the end. Bars 1-3 and 5-7 are the same.



Morning Song ♩ = 72

Original
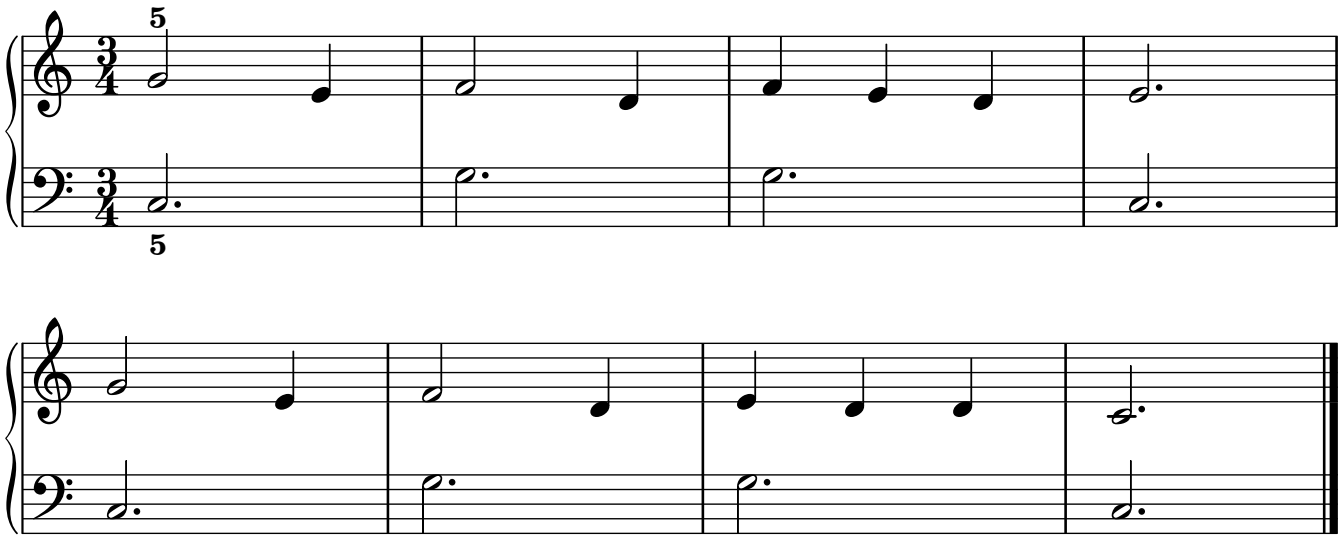
The tune climbs the chain C-E-G in the first bar. The bass changes on beat 3 only in bar 7.



Bells in C ♩ = 84

Original

A waltz: the left hand rings one long bass note in every bar while the right hand sways.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 6?

- Play five Part C exercises you have not played before, at 60 beats per minute.
- Pass if both hands keep going together, with no more than one stop per exercise.
- Pass if every left-hand change lands exactly on its beat.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 6. If not, play Part A again, then try Part C a week later.